When Every Second Counts

Keep this page easy to find. If something feels life-threatening, don't read. Call.

Call 911 if your child:

- Isn't breathing, or has a breathing pause of 20 seconds or more (put 911 on speaker and start CPR)
- Is choking and can't cry, cough or breathe (start back blows, Chapter 25)
- Is struggling to breathe, or has blue or gray lips, tongue or face
- Has a first-ever seizure, or one lasting 5 minutes or longer
- Won't wake up, or is limp and unresponsive
- Has a severe injury or heavy bleeding
- Has lip or tongue swelling, trouble breathing, or repeated vomiting after a food, medicine or sting (give epinephrine first if you have it)

1-800-222-1222

Poison Control, 24/7, free and confidential. Call right away for any medicine, chemical or plant your child may have swallowed, even if they seem fine. Don't make them vomit. Trouble breathing, a seizure, or won't wake up? Call 911.

Go to the emergency department now if your child:

- Is under 2 months old with a temperature of 100.4°F (38°C) or higher (don't give fever medicine first)
- Is very hard to wake, floppy, or can't be comforted
- Is working hard to breathe: ribs pulling in, grunting, nostrils flaring, or too breathless to feed
- Stopped breathing, turned blue or gray, or went limp, even if they seem fine now
- Has green vomit, blood in vomit, or more than a streak of blood in stool
- Shows dehydration: no pee in 6 to 8 hours, no tears, very dry mouth, or can't keep sips down
- Has purple or red spots that don't fade when pressed, with fever or looking sick
- Swallowed a button battery, a magnet or water beads, even if they seem fine
- Had a head injury, then passed out, vomited more than once, or is unusually sleepy

Call your pediatrician today if:

- Your baby is 2 to 3 months old with a temperature of 100.4°F (38°C) or higher (call right away, even at night)
- Fever lasts more than 24 hours under age 2, or more than 3 days at age 2 and older
- Your baby is feeding much less, or has fewer wet diapers than usual
- A symptom keeps getting worse instead of better
- Your child seems "off" and you can't say why
- You're worried. That's reason enough.

You don't need to be certain, and you don't need permission. If you're torn, get your child seen. At your limit with crying? Put your baby down safely and step away. If you might hurt yourself or your baby, call 911. For US families. General information, not medical advice.
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